

Installing Win98 on a 486

Today, everyone needs a computer, but what most people don't realise is that not every application needs a gigahertz monster such as a Pentium 4, 3.2 GHz, or an Athlon XP 3000+.

You pointed out in your 'More For Less' article, in November 2003, that Windows 98 requires at least a Pentium to run on. So, a bunch of Engineering friends and I set off to beat team Digit, and going just that little bit lower. We tried to install Windows 98 on a spare 486 with 16 MB RAM and a 1 GB hard drive, and it worked! It took 14 hours to install, but we could now practise our C and C++ compiling on it. Our next project is to install Windows XP on it. Do pray for us, team Digit!



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Darshan Sukthanker

Via e-mail

Dear Darshan,

Congratulations! Your patience is remarkable. Your 486 with 16 MB of RAM is indeed the official minimum recommended hardware for Windows 98.

However, this excruciatingly slow example just goes to show that anyone using Windows 98 on less than a Pentium will enjoy long, leisurely coffee breaks. It will be interesting to see if you can get Windows XP installed on it—do keep us posted. However, be prepared to put your hard disk through a huge thrashing test, as the swap file attempts to compensate, if the installation does proceed.

All the best!

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Big names missing

Dear Sumod,

You guys did a good job on the November 2003 issue. I loved the second-hand PCs story, and it taught me a lot. I was surprised that you didn't include big brands such as Dell, IBM and Sony in your test drive section, and even left out Compaq and HP in your PDA test. May I know the reason for this?

Nitin Garg

Via e-mail

Dear Nitin,

We do make every effort to get all available products, and indeed, pride ourselves in having comparison tests that cover the broadest range of products. However, there are a couple of reasons why we sometimes can't get every product that you could buy. Most commonly, these products are not sold in an organised way, such as the PDAs you mentioned. More expensive products are usually only imported on order. Also, some established companies sometimes do not want to have their products compared against others, and would rather have customers rely only on their advertisements for information. In such situations, we have no choice but to skip those companies.

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Forum and DVD

I noticed that Digit doesn't answer all Q&A questions, so why not start a forum where people can get their questions answered?

Also, I loved your DVD issue, and hope that you will make it a quarterly affair. You can bundle all the software of the previous 3 months onto the DVD. I would gladly pay Rs 150 for such an issue, because it would solve my storage and backup problems by having all my favourite software on a single DVD.

Vaibhav Mehra

Via e-mail

Dear Vaibhav,

Digit already has such a forum, at www.thinkdigit.com/forum, which you are welcome to join. We have a lively group of readers who may be able to assist you with your problems, and you can share your experiences to help some of your fellow readers.

The concept of distributing software on DVD-ROM on a regular basis has a little way to go. Many of you do not have access to DVD drives, so we will stay with only providing DVDs that add to the CD offerings, for the near future. However, we look forward to being able to provide much more on regular DVDs as soon as the format becomes more commonplace.

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Thank you, Prayaas Rana

Dear Digit,

I would like to thank Prayaas Rana for drawing our attention to this extraordinary free e-mail alternative to Hotmail, Yahoo!, et al. After reading about it (in Readers Letters, November 2003), I immediately connected to the Internet to give it a go. It was, as we were told, amazingly slick and fast. It was exactly what I was looking for. I was sick and tired of deleting scores of junk mail. It just goes to show how competitive the Internet is, and that there are bigger and better services out there.

Arjun Behuria

Via e-mail

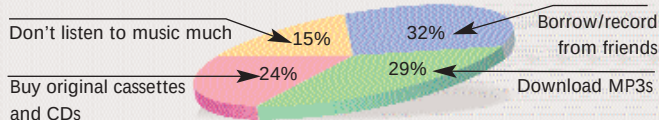
Dear Arjun,

Hotmail with its simplicity does have benefits for people new to e-mail, but may not satisfy power users. The one definite principle of the Internet is that there are always alternative routes, services and options. If, like Prayaas, you have suggestions or tips to share with your fellow readers, do write in to us.

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Q. How do you get your music?



Responses: 2,143

This month's question:

Do you buy second-hand hardware?

- ☐ Own a second-hand computer
- ☐ Own some second-hand components
- ☐ Don't trust second-hand hardware reliability
- ☐ Never considered buying second-hand hardware

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